

APPRAISAL ANNOTATION GUIDELINES

Part 1: Attitude, target, polarity and explicitness

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1 Brief Overview of the Appraisal Theory

Appraisal Theory is a framework that systematizes the linguistic resources we use to express our stances and evaluations of the world (Iedema, Feez, and P. R. R. White 1994; J. R. Martin 2000; P. R. R. White 2003). It aims to identify and explain the semantic systems of choice available in language for evaluating, positioning, negotiating interpersonal relationships, constructing textual personae, and conveying ideological stances. Developed within the framework of Systemic Functional Linguistics (SFL) as proposed by Halliday (1994), the theory also draws on the ideas of Bakhtin (1981, 1982) regarding dialogism and heteroglossia, which emphasize the multiplicity of voices and perspectives inherent in any communicative act.

1.1 Main Components

The APPRAISAL system is structured around three core domains: ATTITUDE, ENGAGEMENT, and GRADUATION.

- **Attitude:** This domain concerns the evaluations that speakers express in their utterances. These evaluations are conveyed through expressions related to people, processes, events, ideas, or objects, as well as through affective responses. Such evaluative expressions may be grounded in social or cultural conventions, personal experiences or knowledge, or emotional states.
- **Engagement:** This component refers to the linguistic resources used to position the speaker's, author's, or other voices in relation to the propositions and evaluations presented in a text.
- **Graduation:** This involves a semantic space of scaling and is related to how speakers amplify or attenuate the force of their statements, and modulate the sharpness or diffuseness of their evaluations and semantic categories.

1.1.1 Affect

Affect refers to the expression of emotions and feelings. It can be attributed not only to individuals but also to processes, events, objects, ideas, or phenomena.

- **Types of feelings:** J. Martin and P. White (2005) identify the categories of un/happiness, in/security, and dis/satisfaction as a basis for classifying emotions.
- **Manifestations:** Feelings may be expressed through:
 - Behavioral processes (e.g., crying) or mental processes (e.g., being surprised).
 - Relational states that convey qualities (e.g., being frightened).
- **Directionality:** Feelings may be directed toward someone or something, or may arise as a reaction to an emotional trigger.

- **Graduation:** Feelings can vary in intensity, ranging from mild to extreme.
- **Reality:** A distinction is made between feelings related to unrealized future states (*irrealis*, such as fear) and those related to present or existing states (*realis*, such as joy).

1.1.2 Judgement

The subdomain of judgement refers to the evaluation of people, human behavior, and entities—such as institutions, social groups, or objects—that are presented in texts as having agency and the capacity to interact with individuals. These evaluations are grounded in social conventions.

- **Judgement types:**
 - **Social esteem:** Evaluates behaviors that are culturally admired or criticized, such as capability, normality, or tenacity.
 - **Social sanction:** Evaluates behaviors that are socially approved or condemned, including aspects such as truthfulness, integrity, contentiousness, or political ideology.

1.1.3 Appreciation

Appreciation refers to the evaluation of objects, processes, events, situations, or phenomena. These evaluations may be based on aesthetic qualities, perceived value or quality, effects, usefulness, and other related criteria.

- **Categories:**
 - * **Reaction:** Evaluates the impact or appeal of something.
 - * **Composition:** Evaluates the organization or complexity of something.
 - * **Valuation:** Evaluates the importance or social significance of something.

1.2 Appraisal Target

Every appraisal is directed toward something being evaluated, referred to as the *target*. This valued object functions as the recipient of the evaluation in the case of judgement or appreciation, while in the case of affect, it serves as the source of the emotional reaction. Identifying the *target* of an evaluation is a crucial step in reconstructing the system of appraisals presented in a text. It is important to note that in some utterances, the *target* may not be explicitly stated, due to features of the language (e.g., verb conjugation), or may be inferred from the co-text or the broader context.

1.3 Explicitness

Evaluations can be expressed either explicitly (inscribed) or implicitly (evoked). Implicit evaluation refers to cases where recognizing the appraisal and its polarity requires contextual knowledge.

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M
		id	original_comment	cleaned_comment	corpus_name	token_count	Annotator	Attitude	appraisal_1	target_appraisal_1	fragment_appraisal_1	sentiment_1	Implicitness_1
1													
2	0												
3													
4													

Figure 1: Example of the Annotation Tool.

2 Annotation

2.1 Annotation Tool

There are various tools available for annotating corpora; however, at the outset of this research, none were found that allowed for annotating fragments embedded within other annotated fragments, nor for labeling explicit elements (*targets*) within fragments or texts. For this reason, and based on previous experience, it was decided to use an Excel file.

The Excel file is divided into rows and columns. Each row contains a comment (text) and its corresponding annotation. The columns correspond to:

1. **Column A:** This is the sequential numbering of the texts in the corpus (YouTube comments). It starts at 0.
2. **Column B:** The “id” corresponds to the identification number of each comment, which was assigned at the time of corpus extraction.
3. **Column C:** The “original_comment” column contains the anonymized original comment.
4. **Column D:** The “cleaned_comment” column shows the preprocessed comment. The valued fragments and targets are taken from this column.
5. **Column E:** “corpus_name” corresponds to the name of the corpus.
6. **Column F:** The “token_count” column presents the number of tokens in the text appearing in “cleaned_comment”.
7. **Column G:** The “Annotator” column contains the code of the annotator responsible for filling in the data starting from column H.
8. **Column H:** In “Attitude,” it must be indicated whether there is an appraisal present in the comment. It is marked with “yes” when appraisal is present, and “no” when it is absent. It is recommended to review the text in “original_comment” to clarify the presence or absence of appraisal.
9. **Column I:** In “appraisal_1,” the classification of the appraisal for the valued fragment at that moment (“fragment_appraisal_1”) must be entered. Appraisals can be “affect,” “judgement,” or “appreciation.”
10. **Column J:** In “target_appraisal_1,” the target of the valued fragment (“fragment_appraisal_1”) must be entered. Targets may be explicit, in which case they are copied exactly as they appear in the valued fragment, or labeled as “undetermined,” “@user,” “implicit,” or “ending”

(see section 2.5).

11. **Column K:** In “fragment_appraisal_1,” the fragment containing the appraisal must appear (see section 2.3). This fragment must be copied exactly (copy and paste) from the text in the “cleaned_comment” column.
12. **Column L:** In “sentiment_1,” the polarity (negative or positive) of the valued fragment (“fragment_appraisal_1”) must be indicated.
13. **Column M:** In “Implicitness_1,” it must be indicated whether the appraisal and its polarity are completely explicit (see section 2.6) or not in the valued fragment. If explicit, mark “no”; if implicit, mark “yes.”

All columns from 1 to 6 are filled automatically after corpus preprocessing.

The **columns from 9 to 13** can be repeated as many times as necessary if there is more than one appraisal in the comment being annotated. The only change required is the numbering, which must be consecutive (for example, “appraisal_2,” “target_appraisal_2,” “fragment_appraisal_2,” “sentiment_2,” “implicitness_2,” “appraisal_3,” “target_appraisal_3,” etc.).

Annotators must ensure that cells are always filled with the category or fragment corresponding to that column. Furthermore, they should verify that categories are spelled correctly, without errors or discrepancies from the original category presentation (for example, no spelling mistakes, no placement in incorrect columns, consistent use of capitalization, etc.).

2.2 Appraisal Identification

Annotators must read the full original text (“original_comment”) and identify whether there is any type of appraisal or evaluation. There may be more than one appraisal in the texts. To determine the presence or absence of an appraisal, the following steps should be followed:

1. Observe if there is any word or group of words that express an evaluation or appraisal of something (identification of evaluative words in the language or its variant).

Some examples of evaluative words widely accepted are: *beautiful, pathetic, idiot, criminal, funny, rapist, harassment, vandalism, destroy, break, abuse, corrupt, offend*.

Some examples of groups of words: *sexual harassment; I like it; it makes me ashamed; it makes me sad*.

It should be kept in mind that there are frequently used words that carry a negative evaluative charge such as: *crisis, machismo, patriarchy, feminazi*.

2. Identify the meaning of a comment, fragment, or word. Determine whether its use in that context is evaluative or not. Some examples may be: *shut up; go cook; great person; feminists nowadays are not like before; graffiti on a wall*.
3. Identify whether an utterance in a comment is questioning another user and, consequently, evaluating what they expressed before: *do you think only men suffer violence?; does feminism serve no purpose?; why do you say those things?*

4. Identify the object (e.g., event, idea, institution, movement) or person being evaluated. This corresponds to the target (see section 2.5). The target may appear explicitly or implicitly in the comment: **there is no appraisal without something being evaluated**. Sometimes, the evaluated object is referred to within the evaluative word itself. In the case of a word like *crisis*, a situation is being negatively appraised. In terms like *terrorist* or *armed group*, the reference of those words is negatively appraised (a person considered a terrorist or a group of armed people with a common purpose). The same happens with words like *feminazi*, *weonas*, *rapist*, etc.
5. Determine if other verbal mechanisms such as interjections, onomatopoeias, or discourse markers express any type of appraisal. For example, a *hahaha* or a *wow* may correspond to an expression of affect.

As observed, appraisal can appear in a single word (verbs, nouns, adjectives, or adverbs) or groups of words (phrases, clauses, entire sentences, or even groups of sentences). Moreover, it can be explicit, when a word with a clear evaluative meaning is used; however, it can also be implicit. In these cases, it is necessary to carefully read the entire comment and take into account the communicative situation (interaction between users on social media) and the topic (video from a feminist collective, performance questioning violence against women and the complicity of the State, feminism, gender equality). If, in a comment, the interpretation has to be forced too much (creating very hypothetical scenarios or dialogues without evidence of their existence) to identify an appraisal, it is recommended not to consider it evaluative. Finally, it should be remembered that in this type of textual genre there is a lot of irony and sarcasm, so an evaluative fragment may appear explicitly positive but is actually implicitly negative.

Example of fragment without appraisal:

- i. “143K feministas vieron este video” (“*143K feminists watched this video*”)
- ii. “@user el hembrismo también” (“*@user hembrism too*”)
- iii. “@user entonces por que luchan las feministas?” (“*@user so why do feminists fight?*”)
- iv. “@user y las feministas también chau” (“*@user and feminists too, bye*”)

In example i., a statement is made about the number of feminists who watched the video in the comments. This assertion does not present any evaluative element. One could propose an interpretation that the number of people who watched the video is “143K” and, for this reason, a user writes that comment implying, in some way, that the only people who watched the video were feminists. Therefore, there would be an implicit evaluation either towards the feminists or towards the video and its relevance. However, we cannot take this possible interpretation into account because we do not have the exact information on how many people had watched the video at the moment the comment was written. In other words, since this fact cannot be verified, it cannot be considered an evaluative comment.

In example ii., something similar occurs, since the words “also” and “hembrismo” could correspond to evaluations; however, due to the lack of context, it is not possible to determine the

meaning of the statement “el hembrismo también” (“hembrismo also”). This lack of evaluative elements and context also applies to examples iii. and iv., which is why they are considered non-evaluative comments.

Examples of fragments with evaluation:

- v. “Y yo me pregunto, a cuantas mujeres han ayudado cantando esto?” (*“And I ask myself, how many women have they helped by singing this?”*)
- vi. “Son los cerebros de las feministas xdxdxd” (*“They are the brains of the feminists xdxdxd”*)
- vii. “Y las mujeres que dejen de ser tan infantiles” (*“And women should stop being so childish”*)
- viii. “@user jajajja segun tu que mujeres hacen esto? las feministas ? porque yo y muchas otras mujeres somos feministas sin hacer eso. Mira jamas me sentire ofendida por el comentario de alguien tan penoso y desinformado como tu. Asi que como he dicho antes, mejor callate la boca porque no sabes nada de nada.” (*“@user hahaha according to you, which women do this? The feminists? Because I and many other women are feminists without doing that. Look, I will never feel offended by the comment of someone as pathetic and uninformed as you. So, as I have said before, better shut your mouth because you know nothing at all.”*)

In example v., the fragment “how many women have they helped by singing this?” can be interpreted as a rhetorical question, the answer to which would be nobody. This interpretation is possible because, since the theme of the song is criticism of violence against women and the “complicity” or “passivity” of state institutions regarding that violence, someone may question the usefulness of making the song and the performance, as it will not change the situation. In other words, the appraisal is not explicit but implicit, and the meaning must be inferred to determine its evaluative nature.

In the case of vi., the statement “They are the brains of the feminists” is accompanied by “xdxdxd,” which symbolizes laughter. From this, it is inferred that the content should not be understood literally, but ironically: they are not the brains (the smartest, the intellectuals) of the feminists. Finally, in examples vii. and viii., explicit evaluative elements appear such as “childish,” “offended,” “pathetic,” “shut up,” or “you know nothing at all,” so they are classified as containing appraisal.

2.3 Attitude Fragment

The evaluative fragment can be a word, a phrase (a group of words with a head), a clause (with a predication), a simple or complex sentence (or utterance), or multiple sentences (utterances); that is, it does not have a fixed length. This is because it is a semantic unit, whose meaning allows the identification of the appraisal. For this reason, **the first step for an annotator will be to determine the evaluative unit of meaning** (see Section 2.2).

If we revisit examples v.–vii., we observe the following: in example v., the evaluative unit of meaning is “how many women have they helped by singing this?”, as this entire segment corresponds to the rhetorical question of evaluative character. In example vi., the unit of meaning is “brains of the feminists,” since to identify the evaluation it is necessary to specify the property or

possession implied by “brains,” because without this the word “brains” alone is not evaluative. The unit of meaning in example vii. is “childish,” which, although it may not have a negative connotation in other contexts, it does have one in this context. This negative connotation (“childish, puerile”) even appears in the Dictionary of the Spanish Language.

In addition, the evaluative unit of meaning does not necessarily have to coincide exactly with the fragment annotated. This is because, first, the evaluative fragment must include the target of the evaluation, if it is explicit, or the resource that facilitates its identification (for example, a conjugated verb or a pronoun), as well as the co-textual elements that allow determining the manifestation of an evaluation. Second, if the evaluation is implicit, then the co-textual elements that guide such interpretation must be included. Based on these considerations, the following criteria are proposed for marking the evaluative fragment:

1. If the evaluative unit of meaning is a noun that also refers to the target, and it is preceded by an article or demonstrative, the article or demonstrative must be included within the evaluative fragment.

Example¹:

ix. “Por fin hay una mujer que no se crea el cuento de las feminazis felicitaciones” (*“Finally, there is a woman who does not believe the feminazi story, congratulations”*)

In example ix., there is more than one evaluation; however, the annotated one is explained here. The noun “feminazi” is observed, which is a negative evaluation (negative judgment) regarding a group of people. This word by itself is evaluative, but it is accompanied by the feminine plural article “las”. Thus, the segment “las feminazis” corresponds to the annotated fragment that will be classified.

2. If the evaluative unit of meaning is an adjective, the fragment must include what it modifies, as well as everything between that noun (or noun phrase) and the adjective.

In example vii., “And the women should stop being so childish”, the adjective “childish” evaluates “women,” so both words must be included in the evaluative fragment, along with any words between them. Additionally, since “women” is a noun accompanied by the article “las,” it must also be part of the fragment. Thus, the evaluative fragment in this example is “las mujeres que dejan de ser tan infantiles.”

The evaluative fragment is copied exactly as it appears in the column “cleaned_comment” into the column “fragment_appraisal_1” (and subsequent ones).

2.4 Attitude Types

2.4.1 Affect

Affect corresponds to the expression of feelings and emotions, that is, to the speaker’s emotional states regarding a person, object, process, or event. In this way, it can express (un)happiness²,

¹There may be more than one evaluation in the examples, however, our explanation will focus only on one.

²Unhappiness is understood as annoyance, anger, rage.

(in)security, (dis)satisfaction, (dis)inclination, surprise, or mockery.

Examples:

- x. “Jajajaja esto es pegajoso es pegajoso jajaja” (*“Hahaha this is catchy, it’s catchy hahaha”*)
- xi. “cariño, yo soy mujer y estoy cansada de que me digan cosas por la calle o me subestimen mor el hecho de ser chica, el machismo sigue existiendo y yo no soy la única” (*“honey, I am a woman and I’m tired of being told things on the street or being underestimated just because I’m a girl, machismo still exists and I’m not the only one”*)
- xii. “no no me enojo que estes en desacuerdo con el feminismo” (*“no, I’m not angry that you disagree with feminism”*)
- xiii. “@user todo tema es para todos unas mujeres pueden hablar de coches y hombres pueden hablar de maquillaje todo necesita la opinion de otro genero y no me estoy creyendo superior odio a la gente machista y hembrista por igual” (*“@user every topic is for everyone, some women can talk about cars and men can talk about makeup, every topic needs the opinion of the other gender and I’m not thinking I’m superior, I hate machista and hembrista people equally”*)
- xiv. “Jajajajaja cuando quiero sentir pena ajena de alguien, vengo aquí, para sentir pena ajena pero grupal, [...] diría mi machirulo esposo opresor; necesitan meditación y yoga.te del” (*“Hahahaha when I want to feel secondhand embarrassment for someone, I come here to feel group secondhand embarrassment, [...] my macho oppressive husband would say; you need meditation and yoga. tea from the”*)

In example x., an onomatopoeia of laughter is expressed, a sign of joy, which is not necessarily positive. In fact, in most cases in the corpus it is negative, since it expresses irony or mockery towards a user, a comment, the video, or the performance. In examples xi.-xii., the users explicitly express an emotional state of tiredness, annoyance, and even hatred. Finally, in example xiv., the affective reaction of “feeling secondhand embarrassment” is explicitly expressed.

When a fragment is identified in which there is an appraisal corresponding to an affect, “**affect**” must be placed in the column “appraisal.1” (or subsequent columns).

2.4.2 Judgement

The judgment subdomain groups evaluative expressions about people and objects or institutions presented as social agents. An object, idea, or institution is considered a social agent if it is presented as performing actions that affect people, that is, if it has agency. The appraisal can be directed either to the person or object itself or to their way of acting.

- xv. “**A LAVAR LOS PLATOS!!!!**” (*“WASH THE DISHES!!!!”*)
- xvi. “**mejor callate la boca** porque **no sabes nada de nada.**” (*“better shut your mouth because you don’t know anything at all.”*)
- xvii. “No es la culpa de una qué **no sirvas para nada**” (*“It’s not one’s fault that you’re good for nothing”*)
- xviii. “Soy mujer y estoy ofendida de las **sapo cliadas sin papás con esquizofrenia de las feministas**” (*“I’m a woman and I’m offended by the sick-ass snitches without parents with schizophrenia feminists”*)
- xix. “**si tanto odian a los hombres porque cortan el pelo y se visten como hombres**”

jajajajajajaja el machismo gano de nuevo” (*“if you hate men so much, why do you cut your hair and dress like men hahahhahahaha sexism won again”*)

In example xv., someone is told to wash the dishes (this could be a user or women in the performance). Although this statement is not explicitly evaluative, it is implicitly so, because its meaning is to indicate that women cannot speak, give opinions, express themselves, or criticize, but rather should dedicate themselves to household chores. In other words, it corresponds to an implicit evaluative expression, whose target is generally a female person.

In example xvi., through another linguistic resource, it is also implied that a user should stop expressing opinions, effectively being silenced. Silencing is not an explicit evaluation, but it is more frequent and therefore clearer. In this example, the reason is also made explicit by an evaluation of the user: “you don’t know anything at all.” Thus, in this example there are two judgments.

In example xvii., something similar happens to the previous one, where an evaluation towards a user is expressed by saying “you’re good for nothing.”

In example xviii., several explicit evaluations are expressed towards feminists: “sapo (*snitches*)”, “qliadas” (*culiadas, sick-ass*), “sin papás (*without parents*)”, “con esquizofrenia (*with schizophrenia*)”, each of which corresponds to a judgment. Example xix. is more complex. To express the appraisal, a conditional structure is used, with a rhetorical question containing spelling mistakes (which should be understood as *Why do they cut their hair and dress like men?*). Through this evaluative structure, women (or specifically feminists) are questioned for their inconsistency, since on one hand they supposedly hate men, but on the other, they imitate them in certain ways.

In the column “appraisal_1” (or subsequent columns), “**judgement**” should be placed whenever the evaluative fragment corresponds to judgment.

2.4.3 Appreciation

Appreciation corresponds to evaluative expressions about inanimate objects (events, things, processes, ideas). The appraisal can be made from aesthetic aspects, quality, effects, usefulness, among other perspectives.

xx. “Ta **chida** la rola” (*“The song is **cool**”*)

xxi. “weon en verdad es **muy mala** la canción **no tiene buen ritmo ni buen coro**” (*“dude, honestly, the song is **very bad**, it **has neither good rhythm nor a good chorus**”*)

xxii. “El Patriarcado es **inmortal e invencible**, las pañuelo verde son como una mosca ante sus **formidables** poderes patriarcales. Ahora si me disculpan, seguiré gozando mis privilegios de hombre blanco heterosexual que las feministas no tendrán nunca.” (*“The Patriarchy is **immortal and invincible**, the green scarf protesters are like a fly against its **formidable** patriarchal powers. Now, if you’ll excuse me, I’ll keep enjoying my privileges as a white heterosexual man that feminists will never have.”*)

xxiii. “El que Educa al partiarcado es la mujer. **No tiene sentido este Feminismo Tóxico**”

(*“The one who educates the patriarchy is the woman. **This Toxic Feminism makes no sense**”*)

xxiv. “@user si tienes razón los hombres también sufren de violencia pero de cada 100 mujeres que son asesinadas solo 1 muere por acusaciones falsas” (*“@user you’re right men also suffer violence but out of every 100 women who are killed, only 1 dies because of **false accusations**”*)

In example xx., a positive appraisal (“chida” *cool*) is expressed about “la rola” (*song* in the Mexican Spanish variant). Since “rola” (*song*) is an inanimate object, this fragment is classified as appreciation. In the next example, xxi., two appraisals are expressed about the “song”: “very bad” and “has neither good rhythm nor good chorus.” These first two appreciation examples are negative evaluations. Additionally, example xxii. shows two positive evaluative fragments about the “patriarchy”: the first is direct, affirming it is “immortal and invincible,” while in the second the “patriarchal powers” are valued as “formidable.” In both cases, inanimate objects are evaluated.

In the case of example xxiii., two evaluative fragments about “feminism” are presented: “makes no sense” and “toxic.” Here, feminism appears as a conceptual entity or as a movement, but inanimate in this comment, so it is classified as appreciation. In the last example, xxiv., the “accusations” are evaluated as “false,” which also corresponds to appreciation.

In these cases, in the column “appraisal_1” (or subsequent columns), “**appreciation**” should be noted.

2.5 Target (recipient or object of the appraisal)

The *target* is the object or person that is being evaluated by the appraisal expression. In the case of affect, it corresponds to whatever generates the affective reaction of the speaking voice. Meanwhile, in judgment and appreciation, it coincides with inanimate objects (events, processes, ideas) or valued people (or animate objects). There are five types of targets:

1. **Explicit:** This occurs when the target is explicitly mentioned within the evaluative fragment. In all examples of appreciation (xx.–xxiv.), the targets are explicit in the evaluative fragments. In these cases, the exact word of the target as it appears in the column “cleaned_comment” is entered in the column “target_appraisal_1” (or successive columns). For example, in example xx., what should be entered in “target_appraisal_1” is “rola” (not “explicit”).
2. **Implicit:** This category refers to cases where the target is clear from the fragment but does not appear explicitly there; instead, it appears in a previous sentence or comment, or is inferred from contextual knowledge.

xxv. “Tipico comentario de un violador” (*“Typical comment from a **rapist**”*)

In example xxv., someone who made a comment is being evaluated, but the fragment itself does not explicitly mention the person; it is inferred that it corresponds to the author (“a rapist”) of the “comment.” In this example, the target to enter in “target_appraisal_1” is *implicit*.

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3. **@user:** This category is used when the recipient of the appraisal is a user mentioned within the comment, i.e., they may be outside the evaluative fragment but still inside the comment.

xxvi. “@user te cuento **pedazo de idiota** las feminazis no existen y comenté otra cosa de puros weones que hablan cosas como “ve a la cocina” y eso no tiene nada que ver con superioridad” (“@user I tell you, **piece of idiot**, *feminazis don’t exist and I commented on other stuff about idiots who say things like “go to the kitchen” and that has nothing to do with superiority.*”)

In this example, @user is being called “piece of idiot.” The column “target_appraisal.1” should contain **@user**.

4. **Ending:** Use **ending** in “target_appraisal.1” (or subsequent columns) when the target does not appear in the evaluative fragment but is inferred from verbal conjugation, specifically for first and second person singular and plural. When the second person plural (e.g., *you all*) appears, one must be sure the comment is directed to someone specific, so it is not a third-person plural (*they went*). In these cases, verify that @user does not appear as the target.
5. **Undetermined:** The category **undetermined** will be used when it is not possible to determine the appraisal’s recipient for any of the above reasons.

xxvii. “@user entonces **si tienen mas facilidades para conseguir trabajos** eso es machismo? Que wea” (“@user so **if they have more ease getting jobs** is that sexism? What the heck”)

In example xxvii., a collective target is affirmed to have “more ease.” The reference for this target does not appear in the comment. It might be guessed to be women, but there is no certainty. When there is no certainty about the target in either the evaluative fragment or the comment, **undetermined** should be entered in “target_appraisal.1.”

2.6 Explicitness

Implicitness refers to whether the evaluation is explicit or not. Evaluations can be expressed explicitly (inscribed) or implicitly (evoked). In the column “implicitness.1” (and subsequent ones), it should be noted whether the evaluation is implicit or not: **mark “yes” when it is implicit and “no” when it is explicit. Yes = implicit No = explicit**

Some of the most frequent linguistic resources used to express implicit evaluations are:

1. *Rhetorical questions:* in several comments rhetorical questions are posed, which do not seek an answer but rather question or mock (negatively evaluate) the propositional content of the question.

xxviii. “@user **no buscaban equidad?**” (“@user **weren’t they seeking equity?**”)

In this example, xxviii., a rhetorical question is used to implicitly negatively evaluate feminists, as it questions their pursuit of equity.

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2. *Onomatopoeic laughter*: laughter represented graphically onomatopoeically as “jajaja” (and its variants) frequently appears in comments. Generally, its use is negatively evaluative; it is a form of mockery or questioning of the video, a comment, or a user. Through this expression of an affective reaction such as joy, something is ironically disparaged or ridiculed.

xxix. “**Jajaja** Nmmms esta cancion me sigue dando un chingo de risa por la letra cagada que le pusieron las viejas **jajaj** Nmmms” (“**Jajaja** Nmmms this song still makes me laugh a lot because of the crappy lyrics the old ladies put on it **jajaj** Nmmms”)

In example xxix., there is an implicit negative evaluation, apparently about the lyrics of the performance’s song, expressed through the onomatopoeic laughter resource.

3. *Mandate to do household chores*: a particular feature of this corpus is the presence of commands to do household chores, mostly directed at women. This mandate is an implicit negative evaluation because its aim is to delegitimize women, to condemn their authority to express opinions. The most frequent command is to make dinner, as in example xxx., but there are also commands to wash dishes or clothes, or to clean.

xxx. “Ahora **a casa que hay que hacer la cenaaaaa**” (“*Now home, because dinner needs to be madeee*”)

4. *Mandate to stop talking*: the corpus also contains commands to be silent. This linguistic resource, besides being an act of speech as a command, is a delegitimization toward another voice, generally another user. This is clearly seen in example xxxi. We consider this resource an implicit negative evaluation because it disparages someone who spoke in a non-hierarchical space.

xxxi. “@user **callate** pendeja” (“*user shut up idiot*”)

3 Corpus Characteristics

The corpus consists of YouTube comments based on a video from the Costa Rican newspaper La Nación. The video is about reenactments in different places around the world of the performance *Un violador en tu camino* (*A Rapist in Your Path*) by the feminist collective LasTesis. The content of the performance is a denunciation and critique of sexual and structural violence against women and the complicity of State institutions.

The comments were reviewed, and only those in Spanish were kept. Additionally, through an automated process, only the comments that referred to the video or the theme of the performance were selected. There are direct comments on the video as well as replies to those comments. The corpus is composed of comments extracted from the social media platform YouTube. Finally, a “cleaning” of the comments was performed by removing elements that will not be analyzed (emojis, strange symbols) and protecting the identity of the users (by replacing usernames).

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